

Licious Predictable Meat, Delivered

Converting on-demand chaos into scheduled demand —
a strategic product working session on delivery reliability
and the logistics of subscription.

The Problem

The diagnostic starting point was a recurring pattern in App Store reviews: customers with a genuine daily or weekly demand for a specific cut of meat kept struggling with timely delivery — not because delivery was slow, but because it was **unpredictable**. A 60-minute delivery window, reliably kept, beat a 30-minute window that regularly broke its promise.

"I noticed a consistent pattern where customers had to repeatedly struggle with timely delivery of orders, specially when there is a regular demand of a specific cut of meat that was consumed everyday." — highlighted from recent App Store reviews

The root cause traced back to a product gap: the app had no way to schedule recurring "staple" orders, so it treated a customer's fixed weekly routine as fresh, unplanned demand every single time. That gap cascades downstream:

Product Gap → No way to schedule recurring "staple" orders; the app treats weekly routines as unplanned demand

Operational Impact → Unpredictable demand forces overlapping routing and wastage; riders assigned to random routes with no advance signal

Front-End Symptom → Unpredictable delivery windows — the #1 voiced complaint across the majority of the base

Business Cost → Delays compound into support tickets and permanent churn among repeat buyers

The Users

Three distinct occasions drive demand, each with a different job to be done:

The Impulse Cook

TARGET

Urban singles & couples, quick-commerce natives (~55% of users)

JOB TO BE DONE

Get dinner sorted in the next 30 minutes

BASKET

Small (~₹400–600)

NEED

Speed and zero friction

The Household Planner

TARGET

Families & home cooks

JOB TO BE DONE

Have exactly what I need, arriving exactly when I said I'd be home

BASKET

Largest (multi-SKU, whole cuts)

NEED

Precision on timing and trust

The Creature of Habit

TARGET

Fixed-routine households (top 10–15% of repeaters)

JOB TO BE DONE

Chicken every Sunday, fish every Wednesday — don't make me think about it

BASKET

Medium, but strictly committed

NEED

Predictability with zero admin

The Approach — Prioritizing by Impact

Rather than move on gut feel, each problem was scored as **Impact = Reach × Severity**:

Rank	Problem	Reach	Severity
1	No recurring-order scheduling	Top 10–15% repeaters	High (core unmet job)
2	Unpredictable delivery windows	Majority of base	High (#1 voiced complaint)
3	Routing & wastage inefficiency	All orders	High, indirect / cost-side
4	Support tickets & churn	Repeat buyers	Medium (symptom)
5	Flash vs. quick-commerce habit	Impulse Cook segment	Medium (competitive)

Strategic note: Scheduling and delivery predictability rank highest because they unlock the others. Solving these two root problems mathematically "buys down" the downstream wastage and churn problems.

Solutions for the Top Problems

Fixing unpredictability — rebuilding delivery trust

- **Provable guarantees:** a delivery-by time tied to a financial penalty (e.g., delivery by 7:00 PM or ₹50 cashback), shown only when operationally feasible — nearby stores, low rider load, pre-order and subscription slots — forcing internal logistics discipline rather than becoming an empty promise.
- **Proactive transparency:** delay alerts pushed before the customer has to complain, with live rider capacity shown at checkout to prevent over-promising.

Making routine the product — scheduled demand

- **The flexible engine:** a weekly/custom-day subscription layer (chicken/eggs daily-to-weekly, fish/mutton weekly-to-monthly), fully editable and skippable, layered onto the existing Infiniti membership rather than sold separately.
- **Zero-admin activation:** a one-tap "repeat this every week" surfaced directly from past staple purchases — formalizing a habit that already exists instead of requiring a new onboarding flow.

Precedent check: ButcherBox (US) shows subscription share eroding under cost pressure (~90% down to ~78%) as customers drift to à la carte — the lesson is to keep loosening rigidity and optimize for LTV, not just acquisition. FreshToHome (India/UAE) anchors on high-frequency staples like milk and eggs, with meat riding along rather than anchoring the box — while still posting a net loss (₹146 Cr in FY25). Neither precedent supports a rigid, meat-only subscription box. Since Licious's Flash and Slot layers already carry the revenue burden (₹1,166 Cr in FY26), the subscription layer can stay small, flexible, and purpose-built for dark-store demand predictability.

Prioritizing Solutions — Impact vs. Effort

Do First

- Proactive delay alerts with one-tap rebooking
- One-tap "repeat this weekly" from order history

Big Bets

- Flexible weekly subscription engine
- Guaranteed delivery window with ₹50 cashback

Fill-Ins

- Live rider-capacity display at checkout

Reconsider

- Rigid, curated subscription box — precedent analysis shows meat-only rigidity doesn't hold up to cost pressure and drives churn

Metrics to Measure Success

Two leading indicators form the causal pair the entire thesis depends on:

On-Time Delivery Rate

Goal: reduce delivery delays

↑ **Rising**

% of Orders on Subscription

Goal: increase dark-store demand predictability

↑ **Rising**

If this pair moves in the right direction, downstream unit economics follow:

Repeat Order Rate

↑ **Rising — retention via trust**

Delivery Cost / Order

↓ **Falling — batching & route density**

Delivery Support Tickets

↓ **Falling — less OPEX drain**

Net Promoter Score

↑ **Rising — brand trust & reliability**

Subscription is not just a revenue feature. It is a logistics optimization feature, converting on-demand chaos into predictable demand. It builds the trust and unit economics required to earn the next order.

NOT FASTER. MORE RELIABLE.